

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A7: Guided Composition

Move from propositions through a declared genre scaffold to a coherent Latin draft and a documented three-pass revision

Stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisite	EL-A6 and a passing controlled-imitation audit
Next	EL-A8, Free Composition and Independent Research

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A7. Guided composition

Guided composition reduces support in stages: full Latin frame, partial Latin frame, structural outline, then independent draft. A learner may remain at one stage for several compositions without imposing a calendar.

Guided composition is original composition in which some decisions are supplied: vocabulary, a Latin frame, required constructions, or an outline. Guidance narrows the decision space but does not turn the task into translation. A **partial frame** supplies only some of the architecture; a **structural outline** names relations to express without supplying their Latin wording. An **independent draft** chooses its own wording within the task's remaining constraints, though it may still consult references.

On completing this unit, you can:

- plan content in propositions before selecting Latin structures;
- compose a collect-shaped exercise and a prose paragraph;
- revise through separate grammatical and stylistic passes; and
- use models as evidence without patchwriting them together.

1.1 Proposition before sentence

An **architecture** is the planned set of clause types and dependency relations that expresses the propositions. Planning propositions first does not mean drafting polished English for later word-for-word conversion.

Write the intended claims in spare logical form, not polished English:

address God; recall an act; petition for a disposition; state the desired end.

Choose a Latin architecture for each relation. Only then select vocabulary. This prevents elegant English from dictating un-Latin structures.

1.2 Four guided forms

Collect-shaped exercise

Supply an address, relative ground, main petition, and purpose/result. Limit the first draft to one finite main petition and no more than two subordinate clauses. Label the result “composition exercise,” never “Collect for use.”

Narrative paragraph

Retell a short Gospel scene in 80–120 words. Control tense perspective, pronoun reference, direct/indirect speech, and coordination. Compare with the Vulgate only after the first draft, then revise consciously rather than copying.

Expository paragraph

Define a liturgical or theological term in Latin, distinguish it from a nearby term, and give one example. Use relative clauses and at least one participial compression.

Commentary note

Write a 100-word Latin explanation of one grammatical decision in a proper. This joins metalanguage, citation, and prose cohesion.

Metalanguage is language used to describe language—terms such as *verbum finitum*, *subiectum*, or *casus dativus*. A **citation** identifies the wording or authority on which a claim relies; it is not a substitute for stating the grammatical argument.

1.3 Three-pass revision

1. **Skeleton pass**: finite verbs, subjects, clause relations, sequence, and required complements.
2. **Concord pass**: every noun/adjective/participle/pronoun relation, case government, and reference.
3. **Idiom pass**: attested vocabulary, unnecessary pronouns, connective logic, repetition, order, and cadence on the page.

Keep all drafts. Copy the final version by hand only after explaining each substantive revision in the margin.

A **revision** changes a draft after diagnosing how well it realizes the intended proposition, grammar, and register. It differs from **correction**, which repairs a demonstrated error: a grammatically correct sentence may still need revision for reference, order, or cohesion. A **substantive revision** changes meaning, structure, or a defensible lexical choice, rather than merely spelling or presentation.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Proposition before sentence — transfer practice

Connection. Planning relations first prevents vocabulary search from deciding the thought.

Transfer task. Write six English proposition cards for one project: agent, action, object, ground, contrast or circumstance, and intended end. Join them with labeled arrows before choosing Latin.

Retrieval check. Remove one card and state which later clause would lose its governor or purpose.

1.2 Four guided forms: choosing a form — transfer practice

Connection. Genre choice should follow communicative purpose and evidence, not whichever model offers the most reusable wording.

Transfer task. For the same proposition set, outline how Collect, narrative, exposition, and commentary would organize it; select one and state why.

Retrieval check. Name one structural demand unique to the selected form.

1.3 Collect-shaped exercise — transfer practice

Connection. A Collect-shaped composition is an instructional architecture, not a newly authorized liturgical prayer.

Transfer task. Using project content, draft address, ground, petition, and intended end in four separate lines before joining them.

Retrieval check. Label the governor of every subordinate clause.

1.4 Narrative paragraph — transfer practice

Connection. A narrative plan needs stable participants, ordered events, background, and a controlled tense system.

Transfer task. Turn four project events into a participant/tense ledger, then draft a five-sentence Latin narrative without copying a Gospel sequence.

Retrieval check. For every pronoun, identify its antecedent from the ledger.

1.5 Expository paragraph — transfer practice

Connection. Exposition defines, distinguishes, and supports a claim rather than merely naming a theme.

Transfer task. Write one project definition, one contrast, one example, and one conclusion in Latin; underline the connective making each relation explicit.

Retrieval check. State the deciding feature in the definition.

1.6 Commentary note — transfer practice

Connection. Commentary moves from an exact form through syntax to a restrained interpretive observation.

Transfer task. Select one form already printed in the lesson and write morphology, governor, clause role, contextual sense, and one limited observation in five sentences.

Retrieval check. Cross out any sentence not supported by the form or its immediate context.

1.7 Three-pass revision — transfer practice

Connection. Separate passes expose structural errors before surface polish hides them.

Transfer task. Mark the actual first draft in three colors: skeleton for finite spine and clause attachment, concord for morphology/agreement/reference, and idiom for model-supported diction and order.

Retrieval check. Record one change from each pass and the rule behind it.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

A7 worksheet family: guided composition

Worksheet IV.25 — Proposition planning

Worksheet ID: IV.25

Focus: Design relations before sentences.

Use: Begin every longer composition here.

1. Reduce this intention to propositions: address God, recall creation of light, ask for understanding, state purpose of faithful action.

-
2. Choose a finite main petition from *da*, *concede*, *præsta*, *illumina*; state its government.

-
3. Choose a past divine act and form a relative clause.

-
4. Write a purpose clause for “so that we may act faithfully.”

-
5. Combine the plan into one collect-shaped composition exercise.
-

Worksheet IV.28 — Three-pass revision

Worksheet ID: IV.28

Focus: Separate structural and stylistic work.

Use: Use a completed draft, not a clean copy.

1. Skeleton pass: list every finite verb, subject, clause type, and required complement.

-
2. Concord pass: draw arrows for every agreement and pronoun antecedent.

-
3. Idiom pass: circle five phrases most likely dictated by English.

-
4. What must be preserved when revising for style?

-
5. Copy the final version by hand and annotate three substantive revisions.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Produce one coherent, explicitly instructional Latin composition whose propositions, clause architecture, reference, agreement, lexicon, and revision history can each be defended from the plan and checked models.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-A8, Free Composition and Independent Research.

If it is not met: Worksheets IV.26 and IV.27 remain optional guided-narrative and guided-exposition practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Proposition before sentence — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing plan contains complete propositions and explicit relations. The model identifies the dependent proposition whose role would become unclear, rather than merely shortening the eventual wording.

Four guided forms: choosing a form — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The outlines differ in discourse job and architecture. A valid choice cites purpose and required structure, and explicitly rejects wholesale borrowing from a received model.

Collect-shaped exercise — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model remains labeled project-composed, has one recoverable petition spine, and attaches ground and desired end unambiguously. Formulaic wording is documented if borrowed.

Narrative paragraph — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing narrative preserves event order and participant reference, distinguishes background from completed action where claimed, and records any model idiom used.

Expository paragraph — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model's definition gives a genus or category and a differentiating feature; contrast and example genuinely test that feature. A string of synonyms is not exposition.

Commentary note — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Every retained sentence traces to the printed lesson evidence. Broader theology, history, or source claims require their own checked evidence and may be omitted without penalty.

Three-pass revision — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model preserves the marked first draft, gives a reason for every substantive change, and never treats stylistic preference as a substitute for correcting government or agreement.

CHAPTER 2

A7 worksheet family: guided composition

Solution IV.25 — Proposition planning

Worksheet ID: IV.25

Focus: Design relations before sentences.

Use: Begin every longer composition here.

1. Reduce this intention to propositions: address God, recall creation of light, ask for understanding, state purpose of faithful action.
Answer / model: Model outline: vocative address; relative clause with past divine act; imperative petition + object/dative; *ut* purpose clause with faithful action.
2. Choose a finite main petition from *da*, *concede*, *præsta*, *illumina*; state its government.
Answer / model: Examples: *da/concede/præsta nobis* + object/infinite or *ut* clause; *illumina mentes nostras* takes accusative object.

3. Choose a past divine act and form a relative clause.

Answer / model: Model: *qui lucem creavisti*; *qui* nominative subject, *lucem* object, *creavisti* perfect active 2 singular.

4. Write a purpose clause for “so that we may act faithfully.”

Answer / model: *ut fideliter agamus*.

5. Combine the plan into one collect-shaped composition exercise.

Answer / model: Model: *Deus, qui lucem creavisti: illumina mentes nostras, ut fideliter agamus*. A fuller sound answer may use *da nobis recte intellegere*; label as exercise.

Solution IV.28 — Three-pass revision

Worksheet ID: IV.28

Focus: Separate structural and stylistic work.

Use: Use a completed draft, not a clean copy.

1. Skeleton pass: list every finite verb, subject, clause type, and required complement.

Answer / model: No verb may remain without an explicit or supplied subject and classified clause; repair any broken government before proceeding.

2. Concord pass: draw arrows for every agreement and pronoun antecedent.

Answer / model: Record gender, number, case, and evidence. Correct all repeated patterns and add one ledger example.

3. Idiom pass: circle five phrases most likely dictated by English.

Answer / model: Defend each with an attested model or replace it. Mere dictionary gloss is insufficient.

4. What must be preserved when revising for style?

Answer / model: The intended propositions and grammatical relations unless the writer explicitly decides to change content.

5. Copy the final version by hand and annotate three substantive revisions.

Answer / model: A valid annotation states old form, new form, deciding rule/model, and semantic or rhetorical effect.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A7, *Guided Composition*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The core requires one chosen genre draft and revision. The other guided forms remain models or extension practice, not claims of four completed compositions.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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